Ashton Honnecke

Senior Backend Engineer • Python 3 • Async Messaging (Kafka, RabbitMQ, SQS) • AWS • CI/CD • Microservices

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Highlights

- Backend Python 3 engineer (~20+ yrs); writes clean, maintainable, well-tested code and reads, debugs, and owns Python directly — no reliance on agentic tooling.
- Asynchronous, event-driven messaging: RabbitMQ (stood up and operated), Kafka (producer/consumer development), and AWS SQS/SNS.
- Microservice and API development on AWS (Lambda, API Gateway, S3, SNS, EC2, ECS); databases — Postgres, BigQuery, SQL.
- CI/CD pipelines: Docker, GitHub Actions, CircleCI, fan-out parallel PR test pipelines, SonarQube coverage rollout.
- Speaker: PyColorado — Cleaning Up Your Python Environment: Superfund Site.

Experience

CrewCapable AI – Chief Technology Officer (2025–Present)

Stack: Python, AWS (Lambda, Step Functions, S3, SNS, EventBridge), Postgres, GitHub Actions, Docker

- Built a fully serverless, event-driven AWS backend on CDK: 10 Lambda functions and a Step Functions workflow integrated across S3, SNS, and EventBridge.
- ~86 typed API routes over Postgres with row-level security; 123 forward-only migrations, linted in CI.
- 8 GitHub Actions CI/CD workflows (type checks, migration linting, regression); Docker-based local stack.

Panasonic North America – Lead Cloud Engineer (2020–2025)

Stack: Python, boto3, AWS (Lambda, SQS, SNS, Fargate, S3), Docker, SonarQube

- Built a near-real-time ingest pipeline in Python on Lambda/SQS/SNS with horizontal scale.
- Authored ADRs for event-driven/serverless and serverful (Fargate) cloud-native architectures.
- Released internal Python developer tooling as open-source on PyPI (Consolo, Snifter).
- Delivered an artifact build pipeline and drove a self-hosted SonarQube rollout (>50% unit-test coverage gains).

Digital Assets Data – Sr. Software Engineer / Tech Lead (2018–2020)

Stack: Python, Django, AWS (Lambda, API Gateway, S3, ECS), RabbitMQ, BigQuery, CircleCI, Docker

- Built Python microservices for low-latency extraction of on-chain data from cloud-hosted nodes (pandas; scheduled CloudWatch Events).
- Stood up and operated a RabbitMQ broker for asynchronous, decoupled service-to-service messaging across the ingestion services.
- Implemented Lambda + API Gateway microservices for cryptographic decoding at very high throughput.
- AWS ingestion pipelines on S3, Lambda, and ECS — 100 GB nightly (files up to 30 GB).
- Extracted, normalized, and ingested datasets via Google BigQuery.
- ”Fan-out” CircleCI workflows to parallelize PR tests; standardized unit testing + linting; Docker-containerized every stack.

Earlier (2005–2018)

- Pixelstub Consulting (founder, 2009–Present): Python consulting engagements, including an LLM-driven image-to-structured-data pipeline.
- Havenly — Sr. Software Engineer: designed a greenfield, horizontally scalable queued data-feed system (7M+ rows/day from 25+ sources).
- Photobucket — SWE → Sr SWE: top-50 global web property (~100M users); introduced CI and unit testing to the team; owned MySQL-backed payments and tooling.

Skills

- Python 3 backend development; asynchronous / event-driven systems; microservice and API design.
- AWS: Lambda, API Gateway, S3, SNS, SQS, EC2, ECS, Fargate, Step Functions; Docker.
- CI/CD: GitHub Actions, CircleCI; automated testing, linting, and coverage tooling.
- Databases: Postgres, MySQL, Google BigQuery; SQL data modeling.
- Linux/Unix administration and DevOps (~20 yrs).

Open-Source (Python, PyPI)

- Consolo — hot-mount Lambda filesystems for rapid iteration: `https://pypi.org/project/consolo/`
- Snifter — fast SNS topic/message inspection from the CLI: `https://pypi.org/project/snifter/`

Education

- B.S. Computer Science — University of Denver (2000–2004); Minors: Mathematics, Philosophy.
- M.B.A. — University of Denver (2004–2005).